

SIG P210

The **SIG P210** (Swiss Army designation **Pistole 49**, the civilian model was known as **SP47/8** prior to 1957) is a locked breech self loading, semi-automatic pistol designed and manufactured in Neuhausen am Rheinfall (Canton of Schaffhausen, Switzerland) by SIG from 1948 to 2006.

It is of all-steel construction chambered in 9×19mm Parabellum and 7.65×21mm Parabellum. It was used from 1949 to 1975 by the Swiss Army and police units. It was also adopted by the Military of Denmark in 1949 (as M/49 Neuhausen or simply Neuhausen) and was replaced by the SIG P320 in 2019, and in 1951 by the German Bundespolizei and in shooting sports.

The pistols were decommissioned by the Swiss Army and replaced by the SIG Sauer P220 (Swiss Army designation *Pistole 75*) developed in 1975. Swiss production of the P210 continued until 2006. A new model, the **P210 Legend**, was introduced by SIG Sauer GMBH of Germany in 2010, and another, the **P210A**, was introduced by SIG Sauer Inc. of New Hampshire in the United States in 2017. In 2022, Sig Sauer released the P210 Carry originally debuted at the 2010 Shot Show in Las Vegas, Nevada. The P210 Carry is a pistol chambered in 9x19 Parabellum with a capacity of 8+1. The P210 Carry is lighter and smaller than the original P210 featuring an alloy frame and a 4.1 inch barrel instead of the 4.7 inch barrel on the original P210. It also differs because it has new additions such as the front slide serrations, the Nitron finish, and the black Hogue G10 grips, for a more aggressive and modern look.^[1]

SIG P210

civilian model P210-1 (c. 1963)

Type	<u>Semi-automatic pistol</u>
Place of origin	Switzerland
Service history	
In service	1949–present
Used by	See <u>Users</u>
Wars	<u>Lebanese Civil War</u>
Production history	
Designer	- Max Müller - Charles Petter - SIG Neuhausen
Designed	1947 as SP47/8
Manufacturer	<u>SIG</u> , <u>SIG Sauer</u>
Produced	1949–2005 2010–present
<u>No.</u> built	~350,000 all variants
Variants	See <u>Variants</u>
Specifications	
Mass	970 g (34 oz)
Length	215 mm (8.5 in)
<u>Barrel</u> length	120 mm (4.7 in) (P210-5)
<u>Cartridge</u>	<u>9×19mm Parabellum</u> <u>7.65×21mm Parabellum</u> <u>.22 Long Rifle</u>
<u>Action</u>	<u>Short Recoil Operated</u> , Single action

History

Feed system	8-round detachable box <u>magazine</u>
Sights	Fixed <u>iron sights</u> ; adjustable in target variants

The design was derived from Charles Petter's Modèle 1935A pistol. In 1937, Schweizerische Industrie Gesellschaft (SIG) acquired a license for the Petter–Browning system from SACM in order to develop a replacement for the Luger Parabellum 06/29, which had been in service since 1900. Apparently not satisfied with the Petter Browning design or the changes they had made to it, SIG evaluated no fewer than 11 prototypes from 1942 through 1944. Selbstladepistole Neuhausen model 44/16 pistol production began in 1944. Some of the original Petter Browning features had been retained, specifically the self-contained firing and recoil systems. The Neuhausen 44/16 had a magazine capacity of 16 rounds.^[2]

Development was slowed by the Second World War. After testing various experimental models (such as the aforementioned **44/16** with a double-column magazine), the 47/8 model was adopted in Oct 1948 as the Pistole Modell 1949 (**P49**), and **SP47/8** for civilian market. Some previous series were tested by Swedish sport shooters and by the Danish army (Danish Defence designation **Pistol M/1949**).^[2]

The 47/8 model supported the easy change of the barrels between 7.65 and 9mm Parabellum and a kit to convert to .22 caliber (see table below).^[2]

	44/8	44/16	Mod. SP 47/8	Mod. SP 47/8	Mod. SP 47/8
Cartridge	9mm Parabellum	9mm Parabellum	9mm Parabellum	7.65mm Parabellum	.22 Long Rifle
Overall Length	215mm (8 1/2")	215mm (8 1/2")	215mm (8 1/2")	215mm (8 1/2")	215mm (8 1/2")
Barrel Length	120mm (4 3/4")	120mm (4 3/4")	120mm (4 3/4")	120mm (4 3/4")	120mm (4 3/4")
Sight Radius	120mm (4 3/4")	120mm (4 3/4")	120mm (4 3/4")	120mm (4 3/4")	120mm (4 3/4")
Height	130mm	143mm			
Thickness	32	40			
Weight	900gm	1095gm	985gm	995gm	945gm
Magazine Cap	8	16	8	8	8
Rifling mm	250	250	250	250	450
Grooves	6	6	6	4	6

SIG M/1949 is the 47/8 model purchased for the Danish military and issued version for officers, military police, and special forces, chambered in 9mm Luger.^[2] The Neuhausen pistol was also used by the crew of tanks. Usually called only *Neuhausen* in Denmark,^[2] this model is stamped "P m/49", and also known as "P210-DK". First issued beginning in 1950 to the Danish Army Technical Corps (stamped "HTK"), this remained the standard sidearm in the Danish military throughout 60 years of continuous use, since the 2010s being replaced with the SIG Sauer P320 X-5 Carry.

In 1957, the civil designation (SP47/8) was definitively changed to **P210** according to the company nomenclature policy. Model P210-1 in retrospect covers all models produced until 1965, the designation P210-2 refers to the standard model as produced from 1966 (beginning with serial nr. P 59071).

P210-3 was a police version produced from 1951 to 1964 (serial nrs. P 6791 to P 6840 and P 8001 to P 8893), produced in limited numbers for the cantonal police forces of Basel, Lausanne, and Glarus, with a handful sold on the private market. P210-4 was the model made for the German border guard (serial nrs. D 1 to D 6500). P210-5 and P210-6 were civilian target shooting models made in the 1980s and 1990s. P210-7 was a rarely produced .22lr rimfire model, made in the 1950s and 1960s.

In 2000, SIG sold all divisions, with the exception of the "Packaging Machines" division. The "Small Arms" division was taken over by the Lütke & Ortmeier Group and renamed SAN Swiss Arms AG.^[3] SAN Swiss Arms AG continued production of the P210 for private customers until 2006. From 2010, a new model, dubbed *P210 Legend* was made by SIG Sauer, GMBH of Eckernförde, Germany. This model was exported to the USA until 2017, when SIG Sauer Inc. of New Hampshire began production of its own model, dubbed P210A, made in Exeter, N.H., offered in two versions, Standard (210A-9-B) and Target (210A-9-TGT).^{[4][5]}



Early (first series, second batch) army model P49, slide opened.



SIG Sauer P210A Target model (2017)

Serial numbers

Serial numbers starting **A** are the Swiss army ordnance models. Army models run from serial number A 100001 to A 213110. Those that have a P added to the rear of a serial number that starts with an A have been sold by the Swiss army to civilians. A stamped "P" ("privat") on the front of the trigger guard shows that a weapon was left as a gift to the owner upon leaving the Armed Services.

Serial numbers 6001 to 6028 are prototypes made during 1938–1947. 6033 to 6406 are early model SP47/8 made in 1947.

Serial numbers with a **P** were made for police and for private use, running from P 8001 to P 8250 (1951) and P 50004 (1949) to P 79150 (1975). Serial numbers from P 79600 to P 97950 are private models made by SIG Sauer, Switzerland, during 1976–1984, and P 300001 to P 331536 were made by Sig Sauer (Swiss Arms) during 1983–2006; the jump to the 300000s range marks the transition from traditional forged frames to CNC production.

During 1966–1969, SIG produced a small number of special heavy frame P210-5 models for the National Match team. These are extremely rare, with a total of 46 pieces known in literature. In the 1970s, these heavy frame models were commercialized and offered on the market, with 100 pieces of P210-6 heavy frame pistols (P 76521 to P76620) made in 1979, and 50 pieces of P210-6 heavy frame pistols, made for Hofmann & Reinhart of Zürich (P 79101 to 79150). These pistols represent the pinnacle of SIG pistol manufacture and are extremely sought after by collectors, and consequently almost never offered on the open market.^[6]

Another special edition is numbered JP 1 to JP 500 (1978, "125 Years of SIG" anniversary edition). P 555001 to P 555555 are special collectors' edition of 555 sets of five chromed pistols with gilded controls, P210, P220, P225, P226 and P230, made for Vonbank AG in 1987 to 1990), at the time sold for CHF 12,950.^[7] In 1991, another special edition numbered № 0001 to № 1991 was made to commemorate "700 Years of Swiss Confederation" (*700 Jahre Eidgenossenschaft*), at the time sold for CHF 4,100 per piece.^[8]

Serial numbers starting with a **D** belong to the Bundesgrenzschutz issues (D 1 to D 6500).^[9] The Danish m/49 pistols have their own serial numbers, without a leading letter, engraved on the right side of the slide, running from 7695 (1951) to 35383 (1962). The rare P210-7 .22lr calibre versions have numbers in the range 40501 (1957) to 41762 (1968).^[10]

Gallery



Experimental 44/16 with a double column 16-Round Magazine



Swiss army model SIG P210 of the first series, second batch (Morges military museum)



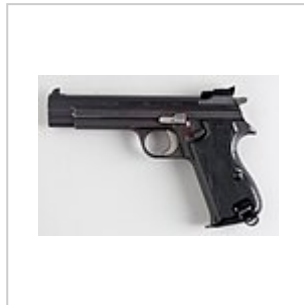
Late Swiss army model SIG 210-2 of the second series, fourth batch (Morges military museum)



A late Swiss army model SIG P210-2 (issued in the early 1970s), stamped "P" for private ownership, with replaced grip plates.



P210-5, a sports/target model produced in the 1980s



P210-6, a target model produced during the 1980s to 1990s



SIG 210 Legend (2010), numbered "25 of 210"



SIG Sauer P210A (2017)

Users

-  Denmark: used by the Danish Defense Force^[11] as **m/49**.^[12]
-  Kazakhstan: Used by the Presidential Security Service since 2007.^{[13][14]}
-  Latvia: used by the Latvian National Guard.^[15]
-  Monaco: used by the Compagnie des Carabiniers du Prince.^[16]
-  Switzerland: used by the Swiss Military and various police forces.^[17]

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 8. now sold at or slightly above the original price tag, auctioned for CHF 4,300 in August 2016 ([swisswaffen.com](https://www.swisswaffen.com/?L=EN&I=m49uvxr2z827) (<https://www.swisswaffen.com/?L=EN&I=m49uvxr2z827>)).
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External links

- [SIG P220](#)
- [SIG P226](#)
- [SIG P320](#)
- [SIG P365](#)
- Description of **Pistole 49**, official Swiss Army webpage (<https://web.archive.org/web/20111006123319/http://www.lba.admin.ch/internet/lba/de/home/themen/pers0/bewaffnung/pist49.html>)
- SIG P210 history and design features (<https://web.archive.org/web/20071119204325/http://larvatus.livejournal.com/33732.html>)
- SIG P210 parts and variations (<https://web.archive.org/web/20091225230132/http://larvatus.livejournal.com/182532.html>)
- SIG P210 serial numbers (<https://web.archive.org/web/20150401222220/http://larvatus.livejournal.com/355024.html>)
- SIG P210-2 disassembly/reassembly (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t3b718Hog_A)
- Commemorative *Confederatio Helvetica 1291-1991* for the 700th Swiss Confederation anniversary (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6_vH998GFt0)

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